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Certified Technical Architect (CTA) Beta Exam Blueprint

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Updated April 2026

⚠ Important Update — April 2026

The CTA beta exam has reached capacity for Pearson test center appointments. Test center delivery is no longer available. Beta exam testing is now limited to Knowledge 2026 (May 4–7, 2026) event testing only. Walk-ins may be accepted if space is available. Conference registration is required to participate.

If you have already scheduled a test center appointment, your appointment remains confirmed. Please see the communications sent to your registered email for details.

IMPORTANT: This blueprint is currently a work in progress and is subject to ongoing updates. The information here provides a general overview of the exam structure and content areas. As the exam is finalized, further updates will be made to the knowledge article. We recommend subscribing and checking back regularly for the latest changes and updates.

Introduction

The ServiceNow Certified Technical Architect Beta Exam Specification document defines the purpose, audience, testing options, exam content coverage, test framework, and prerequisites for earning the Certified Technical Architect Certification.

Exam Purpose

The **Certified Technical Architect Beta Exam** confirms that you have demonstrated mastery in designing scalable, sustainable architecture solutions on the ServiceNow platform. This includes expertise in CMDB and CSDM, technical governance, testing leading practices, go-live preparation, security architecture, data strategies, platform data and integrations, release and instance strategy, and current and to-be architecture planning.

Passing this proctored exam awards you a CTA Certification and a [Credly digital badge](#) to highlight your skills and achievements online.

What is a Beta Exam:

Be sure to review the [ServiceNow Credentialing Program Guide, Understand Beta Exam Requirements lesson](#) for important details on this beta exam. Beta exams differ greatly from other high-stakes certifications.

Intended Audience and Experience:

The ServiceNow Certified Technical Architect (CTA) Beta Exam is open to candidates who are in an accepted state in the CTA program and meet the following recommended experience criteria:

- A minimum of three years of hands-on ServiceNow implementation experience
- Demonstrated ability to translate business requirements into platform capabilities

Prerequisite Credentials

- Review the [Certified Technical Architect Website](#) for the prerequisites.
- Complete the [CTA class](#). *Note: Completion of the CTA course is required to earn the Certified Technical Architect certification. However, this requirement is waived for participation in the beta exam to allow broader candidate access. Candidates who pass the beta exam must complete the training and all requirements before the certification is awarded.*

Exam Preparation

Exam questions are based on official ServiceNow training materials, the [ServiceNow Product documentation site](#), and the [ServiceNow Now Create site](#). Study materials posted elsewhere online are not official and should not be used to prepare for the exam.

ServiceNow recommends completing the following training in preparation for the Certified Technical Architect exam.

- [CTA Class](#)

Additional Resources

In addition to the above, these additional resources are valuable in preparation for the exam.

- [Credentialing Program Guide](#) – a resource to guide you through the entire certification process
- Get Started with Now Create
- System Administrator
- ServiceNow Administration Fundamentals
- ServiceNow Administration Advanced
- ServiceNow Platform Implementation
- Troubleshoot the Now Platform
- Configuration Management Database (CMDB) Fundamentals
- Common Service Data Model (CSDM) Fundamentals
- Data Foundations Essentials
- Introduction to Data Policies
- Data Privacy: Introduction
- Get Started with Encryption in ServiceNow
- Automated Test Framework (ATF) Essentials
- Test Management 2.0 Implementation
- ServiceNow Security Center
- Service Provider Implementer
- Integration Hub Fundamentals
- Introduction to ServiceNow HealthScan and Instance Scan
- Retrieving Update Sets from Remote Instances

Exam Scope

This table shows the exam domains, weightings, sub-topics, and the percentage of questions represented in each domain. The listed sub-skills should NOT be considered an all-inclusive list of the exam content.

Number of Domains	Testing Objectives	Percent of Exam
1	Requirements and Stakeholder Alignment <i>Given a use case:</i> • Analyze current-state versus desired-state requirements to identify architectural gaps and implications. • Evaluate and align solution requirements with stakeholders using demos or prototypes.	17%

Number of Domains	Testing Objectives	Percent of Exam
2	Architecture and Design <i>Given a use case:</i> - Analyze client requirements to architect scalable, secure, upgradable, and maintainable ServiceNow solutions. - Assess trade-offs between client needs and platform best practices to recommend sustainable solutions. - Develop technical specifications that reflect architectural decisions and platform constraints. - Analyze solution components to identify reuse and optimization opportunities across the platform.	33%
3	Governance and Lifecycle <i>Given a use case:</i> - Apply architectural governance principles to ensure adherence to standards and regulations. - Assess alignment of ServiceNow architecture with enterprise IT strategy and roadmap.	17%
4	Communication and Influence <i>Given a use case:</i> - Analyze and communicate architectural trade-offs and risks in business terms to stakeholders. - Formulate an architecture rationale that supports executive decision-making and strategic alignment. - Evaluate competing priorities to negotiate solutions that balance business and technical constraints.	25%
5	Scalability <i>Given a use case:</i> Analyze performance bottlenecks and apply optimization strategies for scalable architecture.	8%
Total		100%

Exam Registration

Step 1: Register for your exam

- Registration = payment.** The beta exam is FREE to the first 120 scheduled appointments.

Step 2: Schedule your exam

- You can schedule your exam directly from this page or later via the My Exams page.
- Schedule immediately to secure your exam appointment time and be guaranteed a chance to participate. Note: this beta exam is 4 hours in duration and options to secure an appointment may be limited.

Step 3: Choose your exam delivery method

- From the My Exams page, you will be directed to Pearson.
- The beta exam is limited to delivery at the Knowledge 26 conference.

Step 4: Complete your exam

- If you do not complete your exam, you will need to wait until the exam goes live before being able to register again.

Exam Structure

Exam Duration

The exam duration is 240 minutes.

Number of Items

The beta exam consists of approximately 180 questions.

Item Types

The CTA exam presents use cases, followed by multiple-choice questions based on each one. Questions may include additional context in the form of a scenario.

Use Case: A short passage describing a realistic situation that provides focused context, such as a business requirement, technical constraint, or organizational challenge. All exam questions are tied to a use case.

Scenario-Based Question: A question that builds on the use case by presenting additional real-world context or details. Candidates must analyze the situation, identify relevant information, and apply best practices to select the most appropriate recommendation or solution.

Multiple Choice (Single Answer): For each question, at least three response options are provided. Select the one response that most accurately answers the question.

Exam Result

Beta exam results are delayed. You will receive a pass/fail determination six to eight weeks post the beta exam window closing.

If You Pass:

- The Certified Technical Architect certification and a Credly digital badge will be awarded upon passing the beta exam and completing the required CTA program training. If training has not yet been completed, the certification will be held until that requirement is met.
- Share your badge on LinkedIn, your email signature, or other platforms to highlight your skills.
- To maintain your certification, complete annual maintenance exams (deltas) and pay the yearly Certification Maintenance Program (CMP) fee.

If You Do Not Pass:

- You will be able to retake the exam once it has gone live.

[Back to Top](#)

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No

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